to the strength and pace of the enemy. Babur and the other three leaders kept on showering arrows tirelessly at the enemy. As it was apparent that Babur's strength in numbers had almost zeroed, the enemy retaliated with even more force and fire. They began to unhorse the remaining men.

Babur thrice or more attempted to rally his men, but all in vain. Defeat seemed imminent now. However, the four, including Babur, kept wreaking havoc on enemies relentlessly without any results. Now the enemies had got behind Babur and the rest. They chased them for around six miles, as far as the rising ground opposite Kharābūk and Pashāmūn. Babur and his men could save their lives by a whisker.

Reaching there Babur met Muḥammad 'Alī Mubashir and said, 'They are only a few; let us stop and put our horses at them.' Muḥammad 'Alī Mubashir seemed convinced by what Babur proposed and they did the same. And when they stood up to the enemy, they became still. Babur's scattered men gathered in from the side, but several very serviceable men, scattering in this attack, went right to Osh.

Babur explains this affair in the *Baburnama* as below:[*]

> Some of Ayūb Begchīk's Moghūls had slipped away from Aūsh to raid near Andijān and, hearing the noise of our troop, came somewhat stealthily towards us; then there seems to have been confusion about the password.[1] The passwords settled on for use during this movement of ours were Tashkent and Sairām. If Tashkent were said, Sairām would be answered; if Sairām, Tashkent. In this muddled affair, Khwāja Muḥammad 'Ali seems to have been somewhat in advance of our party and to have got bewildered, —he was a Sārt person, —when the Moghūls came up saying, 'Tashkent, Tashkent,' for he gave them 'Tashkent, Tashkent,' as the countersign. Through this, they took him for an enemy, raised their war-cry, beat their saddle drums, and poured arrows on us. It was through this we gave way, and through this false alarm were scattered! We went back to Aūsh.

Bābur Again Attempts to Take Andijān

Apart from the aforementioned incident, the returning efforts of clans from the highland and lowland to the other side made Taṃbal lose heart big time however wicked he may have been. Within a week, his military and people started deserting him. They were fleeing to retired places and the open country. To add to Babur's delight, one from the household of Babur came and conveyed to him, 'His affairs are nearly ruined; he will break up in three or four days, utterly ruined.'

Hearing this, the over-excited Babur decided to ride to Andijān again.